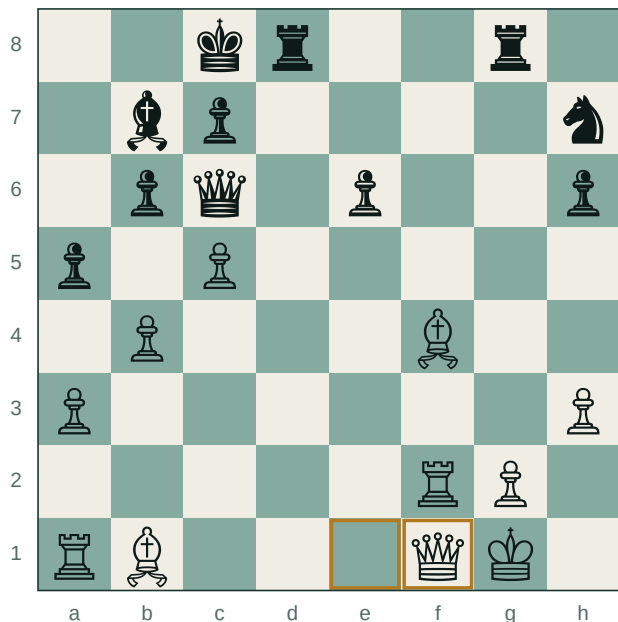


Skewers: Black, move 26

Skewers

Black to move



Previous move: 26.Qf1. Gold borders mark its start and finish.

WORKED CONTINUATION - COVER THIS SECTION FIRST

26...Rd1 27. Qxd1 Rxc2+ 28. Kf1 Rg1+ 29. Ke2 Rxd1

26...Rd1 The rook moves from d8 to d1. From d1 it attacks queen on f1 and bishop on b1. Recorded reply: **27.Qxd1**.

27...Rxc2+ Check restricts White to 3 legal replies here. From c2 it attacks king on c1 and rook on c2. Recorded reply: **28.Kf1**.

28...Rg1+ Check restricts White to 2 legal replies here. Recorded reply: **29.Ke2**.

29...Rxd1 The rook captures the queen on d1.

At the end, nominal material is White 20 / Black 25 (P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9). Over this line, Black's balance changes by +5. Activity and king safety still affect the evaluation.

CHECKPOINT

Using P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9, how much does Black's material balance change over the complete line? **Answer: +5:** the balance goes from +0 to +5. Count promotions and every recapture, not just the first gain.

CARRY THE IDEA INTO YOUR GAMES

The defender may block, capture the attacker, or protect the rear piece while moving the front one. Alignment alone is not enough.

WHAT THIS POSITION TEACHES

A skewer puts the more important target in front. When that target moves, a piece behind it may be lost. Checks make the geometry especially forcing.

HOW TO LOOK

Search ranks, files, and diagonals where two enemy pieces line up. Calculate the first target's legal responses.

The defending king is on g1. Absolute pin: pawn on g2.